

# Olympiad Test Paper — Sanskrit (Class 7) — Paper 4

## Chapter 6: क्रीडाम वयं श्लोकान्त्याक्षरीम् (Let Us Play Shloka-Antyakshari)

### Paper 4 — (progressively harder)

|                        |                                                                      |
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| <b>Subject</b>         | Sanskrit (NCERT Class 7, Deepakam)                                   |
| <b>Chapter</b>         | 6 — क्रीडाम वयं श्लोकान्त्याक्षरीम् (Let Us Play Shloka-Antyakshari) |
| <b>Total Questions</b> | 60 (Multiple Choice, single correct)                                 |
| <b>Maximum Marks</b>   | 240                                                                  |
| <b>Suggested Time</b>  | 90 minutes                                                           |

**Marking scheme:** +4 for each correct answer · -1 for each wrong answer · 0 if unattempted.

**Instructions:** Each question has four options (A), (B), (C), (D); exactly one is correct. National-olympiad depth. Game logic: the NEXT verse opens with the LAST heard अक्षर (full consonant+vowel syllable, e.g. ते not त्), never the last bare consonant or the previous opener; a player who ends on a long vowel (...या) hands over या not य. Sandhi at seams: श्लोक+अन्त्य is savarṇa-dīrgha (अ+अ→आ), निः+गन्ध and साधोः+विपरीतम् are visarga→र् before voiced sounds — distinct mechanisms, do not conflate. The तादर्थ्ये चतुर्थी -आय endings (विवादाय/दानाय/रक्षणाय) are DATIVE OF PURPOSE, not genitive/locative, and they line up विद्या-धन-शक्ति → विवाद-मद-परिपीडन (wicked) AGAINST ज्ञान-दान-रक्षण (good) — same gift, विपरीत use; never swap the triple's order. परेषाम् = 'of OTHERS' (gen. pl. of पर). खल = a fault of WILL (moral), मूर्ख = a fault of intellect; विद्या = studied learning, ज्ञान = realised insight; worth rests on शीलम् (=वृत्तम्/आचरणम्), so the शीलम्-less are भारभूताः (=भारकराः). किंशुक = the bright but SCENTLESS Flame of the Forest; the simile dies if the scentlessness is dropped. क्रीडाम वयम् is a cohortative 'let us play' (1st-person plural, आत्मनेपद-sense exhortation), not a statement or command to others. Do not write on this paper — mark answers on your answer sheet.

1. A player closes a verse on the word शोभन्ते. In strict श्लोकान्त्याक्षरी, the very next verse must open on which अक्षर, and why?

(A) त् — only the final bare consonant is carried, because vowels are dropped at a word's end

(B) शो — the FIRST syllable of the closing word is what the next player must echo

(C) ते — the rule passes on the LAST full syllable actually pronounced, and शोभन्ते ends in the syllable ते (त् + ए), so the next verse must begin with ते

(D) न — the penultimate syllable न is taken, since ते is treated as a mere case-ending

**2.** Two verses are offered as continuations after a verse ending in '...विद्या'. Verse X opens विद्यार्थी..., verse Y opens वीर:.... Which is a LEGAL move and why?

(A) Verse Y, because both words start with the व-class consonant व, and matching the first consonant is enough

(B) Neither, because a verse may never begin with the same word-stem (विद्या) that just ended the previous verse

(C) Both, because as long as the bare consonant व matches, the attached vowel is irrelevant

(D) Verse X, because विद्या ends in the long-vowel syllable द्या (द् + आ) so the opener must carry द्या/the same vya-sound, and विद्यार्थी begins with that very syllable

**3.** Why is it harder, in antyakshari, to continue after a verse ending in a syllable like ङ्क् or a half-consonant cluster than after one ending in a clear vowel-bearing syllable such as नी?

(A) Because verses ending in clusters are forbidden, so the previous player automatically loses the turn

(B) Because a clear open syllable like नी gives an unambiguous, commonly-occurring opening sound to match, whereas a rare cluster offers very few or no verses that begin with that exact difficult syllable

(C) Because only the last vowel matters, so नी and ङ्क् are in fact equally easy to answer

(D) Because a cluster ending means the next player may start with any letter freely

**4.** The chapter's title contains the cohortative क्रीडाम वयम् ('let us play'). If a single child wanted to say 'let ME play' in the same spirit, the most faithful change would be:

(A) keep क्रीडाम but change वयम् to अहम्, since the verb form is fixed and only the pronoun moves

(B) use क्रीडतु, because the singular of an exhortation is simply the third-person command form

(C) use क्रीडसि, the second-person present, since 'let me' is addressed to oneself

(D) shift the verb to first-person singular — क्रीडानि (अहम्), keeping the same 'let ... play' exhortative mood but for one speaker

**5.** Grammatically, क्रीडाम वयम् differs from a plain statement क्रीडामः वयम् ('we play') chiefly because it expresses:

(A) a past action — 'we played', since the dropped visarga marks past time

(B) a command aimed at other people — 'you all play', addressed away from the speaker

(C) a question — 'do we play?', the shortened form turning the clause interrogative

(D) an exhortation / wish — 'let us play', a self-inclusive call to action rather than a report of an ongoing fact

6. At the seam श्लोक + अन्त्य (giving श्लोकान्त्य) and at the seam निः + गन्ध (giving निर्गन्ध), the two sandhis are:

- (A) both visarga sandhis, since each joins two stems across a पद boundary
- (B) both vowel sandhis, since in each case two vowels fuse into a single long vowel
- (C) different in kind — the first is a vowel sandhi (अ + अ → आ, savarṇa-dīrgha), the second is a visarga sandhi (ः → र् before the voiced ग)
- (D) the same single rule, because all compounding in Sanskrit uses one uniform junction process

7. Both साधोः + विपरीतम् → साधोर्विपरीतम् and निः + गन्ध → निर्गन्ध show a visarga becoming र्. The shared CONDITION that triggers र् in each is that the visarga stands before:

- (A) a voiceless consonant, before which the visarga always hardens to र्
- (B) the specific letter र, which attracts a second र by doubling
- (C) a VOICED sound (here व and ग respectively), before which ः regularly becomes र्
- (D) a vowel, before which a visarga is simply deleted and replaced by र् for clarity

8. A student claims साधोर्विपरीतम् must be a misprint for साधोःविपरीतम्. The correct reply is:

- (A) it is indeed a misprint; the visarga should always be retained in print and never resolved to र्
- (B) it is a misprint because साधोः cannot take any sandhi, being a fixed genitive
- (C) it is not a misprint — the written र् simply records the visarga sandhi साधोः + विपरीतम्, where ः becomes र् before voiced व
- (D) neither form is correct; the proper junction is साधोर्विपरीतम् spelled with a doubled र्

9. विद्याहीन is most precisely a तत्पुरुष whose first member विद्या stands in a hidden case. That underlying case and sense are:

- (A) nominative coordinate — विद्या च हीनः च, a द्वन्द्व simply listing 'knowledge and the lacking one'
- (B) instrumental/ablative-of-separation — विद्यया हीनः, 'devoid OF / by-want-of knowledge', the second member हीन governing the first
- (C) genitive of more-than — विद्यायाः अधिकः, 'exceeding knowledge'
- (D) accusative object — विद्याम् हीनः, 'one who lacks knowledge as a direct object'

10. किंशुकाः इव in the simile makes किंशुकाः the standard of comparison (उपमान). The thing being compared (उपमेय) is:

- (A) किंशुकाः themselves, which are compared to their own colour
- (B) शोभन्ते, the act of shining, which is the object being likened
- (C) विद्याहीनाः — the knowledge-less people, who are likened TO the किंशुक flowers
- (D) इव, the comparison-particle, which is what is being compared

11. The simile's force depends on a single shared property (साधारणधर्म) between the knowledge-less person and the किंशुक. That shared property is:

- (A) outward splendour combined with the ABSENCE of inner essence — brilliant appearance, but (like scentlessness) no real worth-giving quality within
- (B) bright red colour, literally shared by both the person and the flower
- (C) growth in a forest, since both the unlearned and the किंशुक are found in wild places
- (D) fragrance, which both the flower and the cultured person richly possess

**12.** If किंशुक is translated merely as 'a lovely red flower' (dropping 'scentless'), the simile's logic collapses because the comparison would then wrongly imply:

- (A) that the flower is more learned than the person, reversing the comparison
- (B) that knowledge and fragrance are the same physical thing
- (C) that the unlearned person literally turns into a red flower
- (D) that the unlearned person, like the flower, possesses every desirable quality — leaving no deficiency for the verse to criticise

**13.** निर्गन्ध (from निः + गन्ध) functions in the verse as an adjective of किंशुक. As a compound its sense 'gone-out-of fragrance / without fragrance' makes निर्- a prefix meaning:

- (A) absence / privation — 'without, devoid of', so निर्गन्ध = 'scentless'
- (B) intensity — 'very fragrant', निर्- strengthening गन्ध
- (C) outward motion of fragrance — 'fragrance pouring forth', i.e. strongly scented
- (D) certainty — 'surely fragrant', निर्- affirming the scent

**14.** Apply the verse's reading-method to a NEW compound निष्फल (निः + फल). By the same logic that gives निर्गन्ध = 'scentless', निष्फल means:

- (A) 'fruitless / without result' — निः- giving privation, फल being fruit/result
- (B) 'full of fruit', निः- intensifying the abundance of फल
- (C) 'about to bear fruit', निः- marking imminence
- (D) 'the best fruit', निः- marking excellence

**15.** In the wicked half of the verse, विवादाय, मदाय and परिपीडनाय share one grammatical case and one syntactic job. They are:

- (A) all GENITIVE, expressing possession — 'of quarrel / pride / oppression'
- (B) all LOCATIVE, expressing place — 'in quarrel / pride / oppression'
- (C) all DATIVE (चतुर्थी), expressing PURPOSE — 'for the sake of quarrel / pride / oppression' (तादर्थ्ये चतुर्थी)
- (D) all NOMINATIVE subjects — 'quarrel, pride and oppression [act]'

**16.** Keeping the verse's fixed order विद्या → धन → शक्ति, the wicked outcomes line up as:

- (A) विद्या → विवाद (quarrel), धन → मद (pride), शक्ति → परिपीडन (oppression)
- (B) विद्या → मद (pride), धन → परिपीडन (oppression), शक्ति → विवाद (quarrel)
- (C) विद्या → परिपीडन (oppression), धन → विवाद (quarrel), शक्ति → मद (pride)
- (D) विद्या → दान (giving), धन → रक्षण (protection), शक्ति → ज्ञान (knowledge-sharing)

**17.** Each wicked use is the exact moral opposite of a good use of the SAME gift. Pair them correctly:

- (A) विवाद opposes रक्षण; मद opposes ज्ञान-sharing; परिपीडन opposes दान
- (B) विवाद opposes दान; मद opposes रक्षण; परिपीडन opposes ज्ञान-sharing
- (C) विवाद (wicked use of विद्या) opposes sharing-of-ज्ञान; मद (wicked use of धन) opposes दान; परिपीडन (wicked use of शक्ति) opposes रक्षण
- (D) all three wicked uses oppose the single good use दान, since giving cures every fault

**18.** In शक्तिः परेषाम् परिपीडनाय, the word परेषाम् (genitive plural of पर) is essential because it tells us the oppression is directed at:

- (A) the self — परेषाम् meaning 'of one's own', i.e. self-oppression
- (B) one rival only — परेषाम् being a genitive SINGULAR pointing at a single person
- (C) OTHERS — परेषाम् = 'of others', so the wicked use power to torment people beyond themselves
- (D) the gods — पर here naming the supreme being who is oppressed

**19.** Consider the new line धनम् दानाय न तु सञ्चयाय. Reading दानाय and सञ्चयाय by the verse's own grammar, the line means:

- (A) 'the wealth OF the gift, not OF the hoard' — both forms genitive
- (B) 'wealth is FOR GIVING, not for hoarding' — both -आय forms are datives of purpose contrasting two ends
- (C) 'wealth IN giving, not IN hoarding' — both forms locative
- (D) 'giving and hoarding the wealth' — both forms accusative objects

**20.** Why does the verse expressly target the खल and not the मूर्ख when describing gifts turned to harm?

- (A) because misusing one's gifts is a fault of WILL (one chooses to harm) — that is the खल's moral defect — whereas the मूर्ख's defect is intellectual and need not involve any chosen misuse
- (B) because the मूर्ख has no गिफ्ट्स (knowledge, wealth or power) at all to misuse
- (C) because खल and मूर्ख are synonyms, so either word would have served equally
- (D) because the मूर्ख is the same as the साधु and is therefore praised, not blamed

**21.** A brilliant scholar memorises whole śāstras yet deploys them only to entrap and ruin honest people. By the chapter's categories he is best classed, and his worth judged, as:

- (A) a मूर्ख, since anyone who behaves badly must by definition be unwise and ignorant
- (B) a साधु, since deep learning automatically confers good character
- (C) worthy and admirable, since his विद्या alone guarantees high worth
- (D) a खल — learned but morally corrupt — whose real worth is low because, lacking शीलम्, his विद्या serves विवाद

**22.** Distinguish two men: A cannot read or calculate but is kind and honest; B is a polished orator who knowingly spreads lies to incite riots. The chapter would label them,

respectively:

- (A) A a मूर्ख (intellectual lack, no malice) and B a खल (gifts wilfully turned to harm)
- (B) A a खल (wicked) and B a मूर्ख (foolish), since the learned one cannot be wicked
- (C) both खल, since each falls short of the ideal in some way
- (D) both मूर्ख, since any failing is ultimately a failure of understanding

**23.** The chapter separates विद्या from ज्ञान. Which scenario is internally CONSISTENT with that distinction?

- (A) a man with much formal विद्या must, by that very fact, possess equal ज्ञान
- (B) a sage with little formal schooling possesses deep realised insight (ज्ञान), while a heavily-degreed man of much studied learning (विद्या) lacks that inner realisation
- (C) ज्ञान is acquired only in a विद्यालय, so no one without schooling can have it
- (D) विद्या and ज्ञान are interchangeable, so saying one without the other is a contradiction

**24.** विद्यालय = विद्या + आलय. Both the sandhi and the resulting word-type are correctly stated as:

- (A) अ/आ + आ → आ (savarna-dīrgha vowel sandhi), giving a तत्पुरुष meaning 'abode of learning' — a school
- (B) अ + आ → ए (guṇa sandhi), giving a बहुव्रीहि meaning 'the learned one'
- (C) no sandhi occurs; the word is a द्वन्द्व meaning 'learning and a house'
- (D) इ + आ → या, giving an अव्ययीभाव meaning 'near learning'

**25.** By the pattern यशस् → यशस्वी ('possessing fame') and यशस्विनी (its feminine), a single word for 'a woman possessing lustre (tejas)' would be:

- (A) अतेजस् — the privative 'lustre-less', the negative prefix marking possession
- (B) तेजाय — the dative 'for lustre', the -आय ending marking the possessor
- (C) तेजस्विनी — the feminine -विनी agentive built on the तेजस् stem
- (D) तेजःहीना — 'devoid of lustre', the हीन compound marking abundance of lustre

**26.** लक्ष्मीः, the chapter's word for wealth/fortune personified, is grammatically feminine. Which fact best confirms its gender within the verse-vocabulary's own logic?

- (A) it ends in a visarga (ः), and all visarga-final words are masculine
- (B) it is the name of a goddess and is declined throughout as an ī-stem feminine, taking feminine concord like नदी / यशस्विनी
- (C) it denotes an abstract quality, and all abstractions in Sanskrit are neuter
- (D) it is borrowed from a verb, and all verbal nouns are masculine

**27.** In विद्याहीनाः न शोभन्ते, the subject विद्याहीनाः and the verb शोभन्ते must agree. The agreement that licenses this sentence is:

- (A) first person plural — to match an implied वयम् ('we without knowledge do not shine')
- (B) third person singular — विद्याहीनः with शोभते ('one without knowledge does not shine'), the plural being an error

(C) second person plural — addressing 'you unlearned ones do not shine'

(D) third person, plural, present — विद्याहीनाः (nom. pl.) with शोभन्ते (3rd pl. pres.): 'those-without-knowledge do not shine'

**28.** शोभन्ते (√शुभ्) carries a middle/ātmanepada-style ending. The clearest reason the verse uses 'shine/look-beautiful' here rather than a transitive 'they make X shine' is that:

(A) the verb is transitive and silently governs किंशुकाः as its object ('they beautify the flowers')

(B) the verb is passive, meaning 'they are shone upon by knowledge'

(C) the verb is causative, meaning 'they cause others to shine'

(D) the verb is intransitive in sense — the subjects themselves shine (or fail to) — so no object is needed; the unlearned simply do-not-look-beautiful

**29.** भारभूताः is glossed in the chapter as भारकराः. Analysing भार + कर versus भार + भूत, the two glosses agree in meaning because:

(A) भूत = 'ghost' and कर = 'hand', so both literally mean 'a burden's ghostly hand'

(B) भूत = 'the earth' and कर = 'tax', so both mean 'the earth's tax'

(C) भूत = 'having become' and कर = 'making/causing', so 'become-a-burden' and 'burden-causing' both describe people who ARE / impose a burden

(D) भूत and कर are unrelated, so the two glosses actually mean different things

**30.** A man is धनवान् (rich), रूपवान् (handsome) and कुलीन (high-born), yet cruel and dishonest. The chapter's verdict and its single reason are:

(A) he is fully worthy, since wealth, looks and birth together outweigh the absence of शीलम्

(B) he is a भारभूतः — a burden on the earth — because he lacks शीलम्, the one quality that confers real worth, however much else he has

(C) he is a साधु, because high birth (कुलम्) by itself secures good character

(D) he is a किंशुक — worthy — because his handsomeness supplies the scent the flower lacks

**31.** Two cousins inherit equal wealth and share equal good looks; one is honest and generous, the other deceitful and grasping. The chapter says the deciding difference in their worth is:

(A) धनम् (wealth) — since it is exactly equal, it is what tips the balance

(B) रूपम् (beauty) — since it is equal, it must be the decisive factor

(C) कुलम् (birth) — which is assumed to differ and so settles the matter

(D) शीलम् (character) — the honest cousin has it, the deceitful one lacks it; the equal wealth and looks cannot decide

**32.** Build a faithful conditional from the किंशुक verse. Which is logically equivalent to its teaching?

- (A) 'If a person is attractive, then विद्या is no longer needed for that person to shine.'
- (B) 'If a person has विद्या, then outward beauty is guaranteed to follow.'
- (C) 'If a person lacks beauty, then no amount of विद्या can help that person shine.'
- (D) 'If a person lacks विद्या, then outward attractiveness alone cannot make that person truly shine.'

**33.** Which chain of reasoning is FULLY consistent with the chapter, start to finish?

- (A) 'He has विद्या → therefore he shines → therefore he must be a साधु, whatever he does with it.'
- (B) 'He is rich and handsome → therefore he has शीलम् → therefore he is worthy.'
- (C) 'He is scentless like a किंशुक → therefore he is wise → therefore he is worthy.'
- (D) 'He has विद्या but turns it to starting quarrels → his use of it is विवाद → he acts as a खल → because he lacks शीलम्, his true worth is low.'

**34.** A debater argues: 'दान and मद both arise from धन, so the verse must treat them alike.'  
The strongest rebuttal is:

- (A) they share the same SOURCE (wealth) but are OPPOSITE outcomes — दान gives outward to others, मद clutches inward as pride; the same gift, विपरीत uses, exactly the verse's point
- (B) they are indeed alike, since any two things stemming from wealth are equivalent
- (C) दान and मद do not come from धन at all, so the premise is simply false
- (D) दान and मद come from विद्या and शक्ति respectively, not from धन

**35.** Synthesising the किंशुक verse with the शीलम् verse, the single principle they JOINTLY establish is:

- (A) outward splendour (colour, looks, wealth) without an inner good (knowledge, character) is empty — worth is decided by the inner quality and by the USE to which gifts are put
- (B) outward splendour is itself the highest good, and inner qualities are decorative extras
- (C) knowledge and character matter only for those who happen to lack beauty and wealth
- (D) the किंशुक verse praises wealth while the शीलम् verse praises beauty

**36.** In a game, a player recites a verse ending '...लक्ष्मीः'. Strictly, the next verse must begin with which syllable, bearing in mind that लक्ष्मीः ends in a visarga after the syllable मी?

- (A) ः — the visarga itself, treated as the final 'letter' to be matched
- (B) ल — the first syllable ल of लक्ष्मीः, since the opener echoes the start
- (C) मी — the carried syllable is the last full vowel-bearing syllable मी (the visarga being only the case-ending after it)
- (D) क्ष — the medial conjunct क्ष, taken as the salient sound

**37.** A player ends on '...क्रीडाम्'. Which proposed next-opener is LEGAL?



- (A) क्रीडति... — because it shares the same root क्रीड् and therefore counts as a match
- (B) डमरुकम्... — because the syllable ड inside क्रीडाम may be used
- (C) मधुरम्... — it opens on म, matching the final syllable म of क्रीडाम
- (D) अन्यत्... — because after a verb-form the next player may start freely

**38.** Why does the antyakshari rule specify the last AKṢARA (syllable) rather than the last varṇa (single letter/sound) for choosing the next verse's opener?

- (A) because a Sanskrit syllable normally bundles a consonant with its inherent or marked vowel, and verses naturally begin on such syllables — so matching whole syllables, not bare letters, keeps the openings recitable
- (B) because individual letters cannot be pronounced at all in Sanskrit
- (C) because the last letter is always a vowel, making 'letter' and 'syllable' identical here
- (D) because varṇa and akṣara are unrelated and the rule simply picks one at random

**39.** Suppose every verse in a player's repertoire begins with vowels (अ, इ, उ...), and the previous verse ended on the consonant-syllable त्व. The player is stuck because:

- (A) vowel-initial verses are forbidden in the game, so the whole repertoire is illegal
- (B) the player may freely substitute any vowel for the consonant त्व
- (C) ending on त्व means the previous player has already lost, so the turn never passes
- (D) the opener must echo the त्व-syllable, and none of the player's vowel-initial verses provides that consonant-syllable opening

**40.** In a four-player round, P1 ends on ण, P2 must open on ण, P3 on P2's last syllable, and so on. If P2 recites a verse ending on the SAME syllable ण, the effect on P3 is:

- (A) P3 is freed to choose any syllable, because a repeated syllable resets the chain
- (B) P3 must again open on ण — the chain can repeat a syllable indefinitely as long as players keep ending on it
- (C) P3 must open on the FIRST syllable of P2's verse instead, to avoid repetition
- (D) the round ends in a draw, since a syllable may never recur

**41.** A teacher says antyakshari sharpens memory AND phonetic precision. The phonetic-precision claim is best justified by noting that the game forces players to:

- (A) isolate and reproduce the exact final syllable — distinguishing, say, ते from त or या from य — to find a valid opener
- (B) recite verses as fast as possible regardless of pronunciation
- (C) translate each verse into the spoken language before answering
- (D) compose brand-new verses on the spot rather than recall known ones

**42.** Two children debate: A says 'the next verse copies the last syllable we HEARD'; B says 'no, it copies the last syllable as WRITTEN, before sandhi'. For a verse whose written close differs from its spoken close by sandhi, the game's practice is:

- (A) to follow the pre-sandhi written form, since spelling is the true authority
- (B) to follow the syllable as actually recited (heard), since antyakshari is an oral recitation game keyed to sound
- (C) to follow whichever the next player prefers, as both are equally valid
- (D) to skip the turn entirely whenever sandhi alters the ending

**43.** Identify the FALSE statement about the chapter:

- (A) 'In the wicked, knowledge serves quarrel (विवाद).'
- (B) 'शीलम् is glossed as वृत्तम् / आचरणम्.'
- (C) 'The किंशुक is offered as a model to imitate, because its fragrance proves its inner worth.'
- (D) 'विपरीतम् marks the opposite uses of the gifts by the good and the wicked.'

**44.** The compound रूपवान् ('possessing beauty') and the chapter-word यशस्विनी ('possessing fame') illustrate the same word-building idea. That idea is:

- (A) a privative prefix meaning 'one WITHOUT that quality'
- (B) a dative ending meaning 'for the sake of that quality'
- (C) a comparative suffix meaning 'more beautiful / more famous than another'
- (D) a possessive suffix (-वत्/-विन्) attached to a quality-stem to mean 'one endowed WITH that quality'

**45.** From खल and साधु the verse forms the genitives खलस्य and साधोः to say 'in the case OF the wicked / OF the good'. The case and its job here are:

- (A) dative (चतुर्थी), marking the recipient — 'to the wicked', 'to the good'
- (B) genitive (षष्ठी), marking WHOSE use of the gifts is being described — 'of the wicked', 'of the good'
- (C) ablative (पञ्चमी), marking source — 'from the wicked', 'from the good'
- (D) vocative (सम्बोधन), addressing them — 'O wicked one!', 'O good one!'

**46.** If the contrast-word were changed from विपरीतम् ('opposite') to समानम् ('same') — giving खलस्य साधोश्च समानम् — the verse's teaching would become:

- (A) stronger — समान would intensify the contrast between them
- (B) false to its intent — it would now wrongly claim the wicked and the good use the very same gifts in the SAME way
- (C) unchanged — समान and विपरीत carry the same sense in this context
- (D) a teaching about flowers rather than about people

**47.** वि- in विपरीतम् and निः-/निर्- in निर्गन्ध are both prefixes, yet they contribute different senses. Correctly:

- (A) both give 'absence', so विपरीत means 'without a path' and निर्गन्ध 'without scent'
- (B) वि- here gives 'reversal / opposition' (turned the other way), while निर्- gives 'absence / privation' (without)

- (C) both give 'intensity', so विपरीत means 'very near' and निर्गन्ध 'very fragrant'  
 (D) वि- gives 'privation' and निर्- gives 'reversal', so the senses are simply swapped

**48.** A ruler imposes crushing, unjust taxes solely to humiliate and break his rivals.

Mapped onto the verse, this is power turned to परिपीडन, and morally it shows him to be a:

- (A) साधु — since collecting taxes is a normal duty of a ruler, it counts as रक्षण (protection)  
 (B) मूर्ख — since only a foolish, not a wicked, ruler would tax heavily  
 (C) खल — using शक्ति for the oppression of others (परेषाम् परिपीडनाय), the wicked use of power  
 (D) किंशुक — beautiful in office but harmless, like the scentless flower

**49.** A wealthy woman quietly funds a free school for poor children. Mapped onto the verse, and judged by the chapter, she:

- (A) uses her धन for दान (the good use of wealth), showing the शीलम् that confers real worth  
 (B) uses her धन for मद (pride), since any display of wealth is arrogance  
 (C) shows no relevant quality, since the verse speaks only of विद्या, not wealth  
 (D) becomes a भारभूता, because spending wealth depletes the earth's resources

**50.** Why can a person be a विद्वान् (a learned, lettered person) and yet, by the chapter's measure, count as worthless?

- (A) because a truly learned person can never, by definition, be judged worthless  
 (B) because विद्या without शीलम् — or विद्या misused as विवाद — leaves a person a भारभूतः; learning alone does not confer worth  
 (C) because acquiring विद्या automatically destroys one's शीलम्  
 (D) because only wealth, never learning or character, can confer any worth at all

**51.** Compare two givers: the साधु gives wealth away as दान; the खल hoards and flaunts it as मद. The DEEPEST difference the verse points to is not the amount but:

- (A) the amount of wealth each holds, the larger fortune being the more virtuous  
 (B) the source from which each acquired the wealth  
 (C) the colour or form of the wealth, as with the किंशुक's hue  
 (D) the direction and intent of use — दान flows OUTWARD to others, मद turns INWARD as self-glorifying pride

**52.** The whole chapter can be reduced to one governing principle. Which states it most precisely?

- (A) more gifts (wealth, looks, power) always mean more worth  
 (B) outward beauty and wealth are by themselves sufficient for a worthy life  
 (C) knowledge alone, however it is used, guarantees worth  
 (D) the worth of any gift or trait is fixed by the inner quality behind it (knowledge, character) and the use to which it is put — not by the gift itself

**53.** A classmate asserts: 'किंशुक just means any pretty flower, and खल and मूर्ख are simply two words for the same kind of bad person.' The single best correction is:

- (A) the classmate is right about both points
- (B) किंशुक is indeed any pretty flower, but खल and मूर्ख do differ
- (C) किंशुक is the Flame of the Forest, but खल and मूर्ख do mean the same
- (D) किंशुक names the specific bright-but-SCENTLESS Flame of the Forest (the scentlessness drives the simile), and खल (a moral, ill-willed fault) is distinct from मूर्ख (an intellectual fault)

**54.** In किंशुकाः इव, the standard-of-comparison किंशुकाः is in the nominative plural rather than, say, an accusative or instrumental. The reason is that इव:

- (A) forces the following word into the accusative as its direct object
- (B) takes the upamāna in the same case as the upameya it is compared to (here nominative plural, matching विद्याहीनाः), since इव is an indeclinable that does not itself govern a case
- (C) forces the following word into the instrumental, as a means of comparison
- (D) forces the following word into the genitive, as 'belonging to' the comparison

**55.** The verse's logic that 'the same gift serves harm in the wicked and good in the साधु' is an instance of which general moral idea?

- (A) that gifts are morally NEUTRAL in themselves; their value is determined by the character and intent of the one who wields them
- (B) that some gifts (like power) are inherently evil and others (like knowledge) inherently good
- (C) that the wicked never truly possess any gift, so the comparison is only apparent
- (D) that gifts automatically improve whoever holds them, wicked or good alike

**56.** Reasoning multi-step: a person has great शक्ति (power) and uses it solely to shield the weak from harm. By the verse this is शक्ति → रक्षण; therefore the chapter would say his power has made him:

- (A) act as a खल, because wielding great power at all is itself oppression
- (B) a भारभूतः, because the powerful are always a burden on the earth
- (C) act as a साधु, because he turns power to its GOOD use (protection of others), the very opposite of परिपीडन
- (D) a किंशुक, because protection is mere outward show like the flower's colour

**57.** Place the chapter's value-hierarchy in correct descending order of what confers true worth:

- (A) शीलम् (character) and विद्या (well-used knowledge) ABOVE रूपम् (beauty), लक्ष्मीः (wealth) and कुलम् (birth)
- (B) लक्ष्मीः and रूपम् above शीलम् and विद्या (C) कुलम् (birth) alone above everything else
- (D) रूपम् (beauty) above all, since the verse celebrates the किंशुक's brilliant colour

**58.** A final synthesis question. Which single sentence most faithfully captures what makes a person worthy according to the whole chapter?

- (A) विद्या rightly used together with शीलम् (good character) makes a person worthy — not रूप, लक्ष्मी or कुल by themselves
- (B) लक्ष्मी (wealth) and रूप (beauty) together make a person worthy above all else
- (C) कुल (high birth) by itself is what makes a person worthy
- (D) यशस् (fame), however it is gained, is what makes a person worthy

**59.** A subtle game case: a verse closes on the syllable या (a consonant य bearing a LONG आ). A player offers a next verse beginning यमुना.... Is this legal, and why?

- (A) legal, because the consonant य matches and vowel length is never counted in the game
- (B) illegal — यमुना opens on य bearing a SHORT अ (ya), but the carried syllable या has a long आ (yā); the vowel-length is part of the syllable and must be reproduced
- (C) legal, because a long vowel may always be answered by the corresponding short vowel
- (D) illegal, but only because यमुना is a proper name and names are barred from the game

**60.** Parse the verb in क्रीडाम वयम् for person and number, then state why the title uses it rather than क्रीडन्तु ('let them play'):

- (A) क्रीडाम is third person plural; the title and क्रीडन्तु are interchangeable, both meaning 'let them play'
- (B) क्रीडाम is FIRST person PLURAL, agreeing with वयम् ('we'); the title invites the speaker-and-listeners together ('let US play'), whereas क्रीडन्तु would push the action onto others ('let THEM play')
- (C) क्रीडाम is second person plural ('let you all play'); क्रीडन्तु is its polite form
- (D) क्रीडाम is first person singular ('let me play'); क्रीडन्तु is merely its written variant

# Solutions — Sanskrit (Class 7), Chapter 6: क्रीडाम वयं श्लोकान्त्याक्षरीम् (Let Us Play Shloka-Antyakshari) — Paper 4

## Paper 4 — (progressively harder)

Marking: +4 correct, –1 wrong, 0 unattempted. Maximum marks **240**.

## Answer Key

| Q  | Ans | Q  | Ans | Q  | Ans | Q  | Ans | Q  | Ans | Q  | Ans |
|----|-----|----|-----|----|-----|----|-----|----|-----|----|-----|
| 1  | C   | 11 | A   | 21 | D   | 31 | D   | 41 | A   | 51 | D   |
| 2  | D   | 12 | D   | 22 | A   | 32 | D   | 42 | B   | 52 | D   |
| 3  | B   | 13 | A   | 23 | B   | 33 | D   | 43 | C   | 53 | D   |
| 4  | D   | 14 | A   | 24 | A   | 34 | A   | 44 | D   | 54 | B   |
| 5  | D   | 15 | C   | 25 | C   | 35 | A   | 45 | B   | 55 | A   |
| 6  | C   | 16 | A   | 26 | B   | 36 | C   | 46 | B   | 56 | C   |
| 7  | C   | 17 | C   | 27 | D   | 37 | C   | 47 | B   | 57 | A   |
| 8  | C   | 18 | C   | 28 | D   | 38 | A   | 48 | C   | 58 | A   |
| 9  | B   | 19 | B   | 29 | C   | 39 | D   | 49 | A   | 59 | B   |
| 10 | C   | 20 | A   | 30 | B   | 40 | B   | 50 | B   | 60 | B   |

Answer-key distribution: A = 15, B = 15, C = 15, D = 15.

## Worked Solutions

**1. (C)** The game hands over the last whole syllable that is heard. In शोभन्ते that syllable is the consonant त् married to its vowel ए, i.e. ते — Sanskrit has no bare word-final consonants here, the opening must echo the first syllable of the next verse not the last word's first syllable, and ते is a genuine syllable of the verb, not a detachable ending.

**2. (D)** The handed-over syllable is the full final syllable द्या, not just the consonant व. विद्यार्थी opens on द्या (vi-dyā-...), reproducing that exact syllable, so it is legal. Merely sharing an initial व is insufficient — the vowel ā is part of the carried syllable — and there is no rule forbidding reuse of a stem.

**3. (B)** The difficulty is one of supply: a frequent, easily-pronounced open syllable such as ऋ is the opening of many known verses, while an awkward final cluster is the opening of very few, so finding a legal continuation is harder. Clusters are not banned, the last full

syllable (not merely its vowel) is what must be matched, and a hard ending does not relax the rule to a free choice.

**4. (D)** क्रीडाम् is the first-person PLURAL exhortative agreeing with वयम्; to make it first-person singular both the person-number of the verb and the pronoun must change together, giving क्रीडानि अहम्. The verb cannot stay plural with a singular pronoun, a third-person command (क्रीडतु) means 'let HIM play', and क्रीडसि is an ordinary 'you play', not an exhortation.

**5. (D)** क्रीडाम् is a let-mood (exhortative/let-type) form, an invitation that includes the speaker; क्रीडामः merely reports that 'we play'. The difference is mood, not tense, and an exhortation with वयम् includes the speaker rather than commanding others, nor does it pose a question.

**6. (C)** श्लोक ends in अ and अन्त्य begins in अ, so two like vowels lengthen to आ — a vowel sandhi. निः ends in a visarga which, standing before the voiced consonant ण, turns to ण् — a visarga sandhi. Two distinct mechanisms; they are not both of one type and Sanskrit junctions are governed by several rules, not one.

**7. (C)** The rule is conditioned by voicing: a visarga before a voiced consonant (व, ण, and the like) becomes ण्. It is precisely NOT before voiceless consonants (where it behaves differently), it has nothing to do with attraction to र, and before a vowel a visarga's behaviour is again different — the common trigger here is voicing.

**8. (C)** The ण् is the regular, correct output of visarga sandhi at the seam साधोः + विपरीतम्, the visarga changing to ण् before the voiced व. Resolved sandhi is normal in continuous text, साधोः is not exempt from sandhi, and no doubling of र is involved.

**9. (B)** हीन ('devoid of') takes its complement in the instrumental/separation sense: विद्यया हीनः, 'lacking by means of / separated from knowledge'. It is a dependent (तत्पुरुष) compound, not a coordinate द्वन्द्व, not a comparative 'exceeding', and हीन does not govern an accusative object here.

**10. (C)** In an उपमा the उपमेय is the subject under discussion — here the विद्याहीनाः — and the उपमान is what they are held up against, the किंशुकाः. The flowers are the yardstick, not the thing measured; the verb and the particle इव are not the compared item.

**11. (A)** An उपमा turns on the property common to both terms. Here it is 'splendid outside, empty inside': the किंशुक blazes with colour yet has no scent, the unlearned looks fine yet lacks the inner worth knowledge gives. It is the abstract pattern, not literal redness or a forest habitat, and the whole point is the LACK of scent/worth, not its presence.

**12. (D)** The verse criticises a LACK. If the flower is described as wholly lovely with no missing quality, then the person it stands for would also seem to lack nothing, and the criticism evaporates. The error is not a reversal, not an identification of knowledge with

scent, and not a literal transformation — it is the loss of the 'something missing' that the simile needs.

**13. (A)** निर्- (from निः) here carries the privative sense 'without', yielding निर्गन्ध = 'lacking scent'. It is not an intensifier ('very fragrant'), not a marker of fragrance pouring out, and not an affirmation — all of which would make the flower fragrant, contradicting the simile.

**14. (A)** The same privative निः- that strips fragrance from गन्ध strips fruit/result from फल, giving 'fruitless'. (The visarga here meets a voiceless फ and surfaces as ष, but the privative meaning is identical.) It does not mean abundance, imminence, or excellence of fruit.

**15. (C)** The -आय ending here is the dative of purpose (तादर्थ्ये चतुर्थी): the wicked person's knowledge, wealth and power exist 'for the sake of' quarrel, pride and oppression. They are not genitives ('of'), not locatives ('in'), and not nominative subjects — the gifts are the subjects, these three are their purposes.

**16. (A)** The wicked turn knowledge to quarrelling, wealth to arrogant pride, and power to the oppression of others — विद्या→विवाद, धन→मद, शक्ति→परिपीडन, in that order. The other rotations scramble the pairing, and दान/रक्षण/ज्ञान are the GOOD uses, not the wicked ones.

**17. (C)** Each gift's wicked and good use must be matched within the SAME gift: knowledge → quarrel vs sharing; wealth → pride vs giving; power → oppression vs protection. The other pairings cross gifts, and a single good use cannot answer all three different gifts.

**18. (C)** पर means 'other', and परेषाम् is its genitive PLURAL, 'of others'; the verse says power becomes the oppression OF OTHERS. It is not self-directed, not singular ('one rival'), and पर here is the ordinary 'other', not a name of the Supreme.

**19. (B)** दानाय and सञ्चयाय are datives of purpose, exactly like the verse's विवादाय/दानाय, so the line contrasts two aims of wealth: giving versus hoarding. They are not genitives 'of', not locatives 'in', and not accusative objects.

**20. (A)** Turning knowledge to quarrel or power to oppression is a deliberate, ill-willed act — the signature of the खल (a moral failing of will). The मूर्ख's problem is lack of wisdom, not malice; the मूर्ख may well possess gifts, खल and मूर्ख are not synonyms, and the मूर्ख is certainly not the good person.

**21. (D)** He has विद्या in abundance, so he is no मूर्ख; but he chooses to use it to harm, the mark of the खल, and because he lacks शीलम् his learning serves quarrel and his worth is low. Bad conduct is not the same as ignorance, learning does not auto-confer character, and विद्या misused does not confer worth.

**22. (A)** A's shortfall is purely intellectual with no ill will — a मूर्ख; B knowingly uses his eloquence to harm — a खल. The learned can certainly be wicked (that is exactly the खल), and the two faults are distinct kinds (will vs intellect), so they are not both of one label.



**23. (B)** विद्या is studied, acquired learning; ज्ञान is direct, realised insight — so one can exist without the other, exactly as the sage-versus-scholar case shows. Degrees do not guarantee insight, ज्ञान is not confined to a school, and the two terms are not interchangeable.

**24. (A)** विद्या ends in आ and आलय begins in आ; like vowels merge to a single long आ (savarna-dīrgha), and the dependent compound means 'abode (आलय) of learning (विद्या)', i.e. a school. It is not guṇa (अ+इ), there IS sandhi, and it is a place-noun तत्पुरुष, not a द्वन्द्व list or an अव्ययीभाव.

**25. (C)** The possessive -वत्/-विन् suffix on तेजस् with the feminine -ई gives तेजस्विनी, 'a woman full of lustre', exactly parallel to यशस्विनी. अतेजस् and तेजःहीना mean the OPPOSITE (lacking lustre), and a dative तेजाय means 'for lustre', not 'possessing it'.

**26. (B)** लक्ष्मी is a feminine ī-stem (a goddess-name), declined with feminine endings and concord, the visarga in लक्ष्मीः being merely the nominative-singular ending — not a gender marker. Visarga-final words are not all masculine, abstractions are not all neuter, and the gender follows the noun's class, not a verbal origin.

**27. (D)** विद्याहीनाः is nominative plural and शोभन्ते is third-person plural present, so they agree as 3rd-person plural — 'they (the unlearned) do not shine'. There is no first-person वयम् here, the plural is correct (not a singular error), and it is a statement about them, not an address to 'you'.

**28. (D)** शोभन्ते means the subjects themselves shine or look beautiful — an intransitive state, needing no object; the unlearned just do not shine. It is not making the flowers shine (transitive), not 'are shone upon' (passive), and not causing others to shine (causative).

**29. (C)** भारभूत = 'having become a burden' and भारकर = 'burden-making'; both pick out the same person — one who is, or imposes, a burden. भूत here is the past participle 'become' (not 'ghost' or 'earth') and कर is the agentive 'making' (not 'hand' or 'tax'), so the glosses genuinely agree.

**30. (B)** Worth, for the chapter, rests on शीलम्; a man without it is a भारभूतः regardless of wealth, looks or birth. The other options reverse the doctrine — wealth/looks/birth do NOT outweigh character, high birth does not guarantee character, and handsomeness is exactly the empty 'colour without scent' the किंशुक warns against.

**31. (D)** Where wealth and looks are EQUAL, they cannot be what distinguishes the two; only the differing quality — शीलम् — can. Equal traits cannot 'tip' anything, and birth is not even mentioned as differing in this case.

**32. (D)** The verse says the knowledge-less do not truly shine despite looks — i.e. 'no विद्या ⇒ looks alone do not make one shine'. The other conditionals invert or misstate it: beauty does not remove the need for knowledge, knowledge does not guarantee beauty, and the verse never says lacking beauty cancels the value of knowledge.

**33. (D)** Possessing विद्या but using it for quarrel marks the खल, and lacking शीलम् he is of low worth — each link holds. The others break: merely having विद्या does not make one a साधु if it is misused, wealth and looks do not produce शीलम्, and being scentless-like-a-किंशुक signals EMPTINESS, not wisdom.

**34. (A)** The verse is built on identical-source-but-opposite-use; दान (giving) and मद (pride) both spring from धन yet pull in contrary directions, which refutes 'treated alike'. The premise that both stem from धन is actually correct (so denying it is wrong), and neither belongs to विद्या or शक्ति.

**35. (A)** The किंशुक verse condemns splendour-without-substance, the शीलम् verse roots worth in character; together they make inner quality and right use decisive. They do not exalt outward splendour, do not restrict the lesson to the unattractive, and neither verse praises wealth or beauty as the ideal.

**36. (C)** The handed-over unit is the last pronounceable syllable, मः; the visarga ः is merely the nominative ending and cannot itself start a word. The opener matches the END of the previous verse (not its first syllable ल), and the medial cluster क्ष is not the final syllable.

**37. (C)** क्रीडाम ends in the syllable म, so a legal continuation must open on म, which मधुरम् does. Sharing a root is irrelevant, an internal syllable (ड) is not the final one, and ending on a verb does not free the next player from the rule.

**38. (A)** An akṣara is a syllable — a consonant plus vowel — and verses open on syllables, so the rule matches syllables to ensure the next opener is a real, pronounceable verse-start. Letters are pronounceable in principle, the last letter is not always a vowel, and varṣa/akṣara are related concepts, not random alternatives.

**39. (D)** Being stuck is a supply problem: the rule demands a त्व-opening verse, and the player knows only vowel-initial ones, none of which qualifies. Vowel-initial verses are perfectly legal, a vowel cannot be substituted for the required consonant-syllable, and the previous player's legal verse does not end the game.

**40. (B)** The rule only ever looks at the LAST syllable of the verse just heard; if that is again मः, P3 must again start on मः. A repeat does not reset the chain, does not switch to first-syllables, and does not end the round — repetition of a syllable is allowed.

**41. (A)** To play legally a player must correctly hear and reproduce the precise final syllable (ते not त, या not य), which trains phonetic accuracy. The game rewards correctness over speed, does not require translation, and uses recalled verses rather than freshly composed ones.

**42. (B)** Antyakshari is an oral game; players match the syllable as it is heard in recitation. The pre-sandhi spelling is not the operative authority, the choice is not left to preference,

and a sandhi-altered ending does not void the turn — it simply fixes which sound to match.

**43. (C)** The किंशुक is a WARNING, not a model, and it is precisely scent-LESS — so the claim that its fragrance proves inner worth is doubly false. The other three statements accurately report the chapter: knowledge→quarrel in the wicked, शीलम् glossed as conduct, and विपरीतम् marking the opposite uses.

**44. (D)** Both words use a possessive suffix on a quality-stem (रूप, यशस्) to mean 'having' that quality — endowed with beauty / fame. They are not privatives ('without'), not datives ('for'), and not comparatives ('more than').

**45. (B)** खलस्य and साधोः are genitives identifying whose handling of the gifts is in view — the wicked's use versus the good's. They are not datives ('to'), not ablatives ('from'), and not vocatives ('O ...!').

**46. (B)** विपरीतम् is the hinge that flips each gift's use between wicked and good; replacing it with समानम् ('same') would collapse the contrast and falsely equate the two. समान does not intensify a contrast (it erases it), it is the opposite of विपरीत, and the subject remains people, not flowers.

**47. (B)** वि- in विपरीत conveys turning-the-opposite-way (reversal), whereas निर्- in निर्गन्ध conveys lack (privation). They are not both privative, not both intensive, and their senses are as stated, not swapped.

**48. (C)** Using power to crush and humiliate others is परिपीडन — power's wicked use — marking him a खल. It is not protection (रक्षण), the fault is deliberate ill-will (not mere foolishness), and the किंशुक image is about empty beauty, not about doing harm.

**49. (A)** Giving wealth to help others is दान, wealth's good use, evidencing शीलम्. Quiet generosity is the opposite of मद (pride), the verse explicitly treats wealth (धन→दान/मद), and giving makes one worthy, not a burden.

**50. (B)** Worth needs शीलम् and right use; a विद्वान् who lacks character or turns learning to quarrel remains a burden despite his learning. Learning does not guarantee worth, it does not destroy character, and the chapter roots worth in character, not wealth.

**51. (D)** Same gift (wealth), विपरीत use: दान is other-directed giving, मद is self-directed pride — the difference is intent and direction, not quantity. Amount, source, and 'colour' are all beside the verse's moral point.

**52. (D)** Across both verses the deciding factor is inner quality plus right use, not the bare possession of gifts. The chapter explicitly denies that more gifts, or beauty-and-wealth alone, or even misused knowledge, confer worth.

- 53. (D)** Both halves of the claim are wrong: किंशुक is a particular tree whose scentlessness is the whole point of the simile, and खल (wickedness of will) is not the same as मूर्ख (foolishness of intellect). The correction must fix BOTH errors, which only this option does.
- 54. (B)** इव is an indeclinable comparison-particle; it does not assign a case, so किंशुका: simply matches विद्याहीना: in nominative plural. इव governs neither an accusative object, nor an instrumental of means, nor a genitive.
- 55. (A)** Because identical gifts produce opposite outcomes depending on the holder, the gifts themselves are neutral and the user's character/intent decides their worth. No gift is intrinsically evil or good, the wicked really do possess the gifts (they misuse them), and gifts do not automatically reform their holders.
- 56. (C)** Power used to protect is रक्षण, the good use, marking him a साधु. Merely possessing power is not oppression, the protective use is the opposite of being a burden, and protection of the weak is substantive good, not empty show.
- 57. (A)** The chapter ranks inner goods — character and rightly-used knowledge — above outward ones (beauty, wealth, birth). It does not put wealth/looks or birth on top, and the किंशुक's colour is criticised, not celebrated, so beauty cannot head the list.
- 58. (A)** The chapter grounds worth in well-used knowledge plus character, expressly subordinating beauty, wealth, birth and fame. The alternatives each elevate exactly the outward goods the chapter demotes.
- 59. (B)** The handed-over syllable या carries a long आ, so a legal opener must reproduce यā, not the short या-of-यमुना (ya). Vowel length IS part of the syllable that must be matched, a long vowel is not freely interchangeable with its short counterpart, and proper names are not barred — the flaw is purely the mismatched vowel-length.
- 60. (B)** क्रीडाम् agrees with वयम् as first-person plural, a self-inclusive 'let us play' that draws speaker and audience into the game — unlike क्रीडन्तु, a third-person exhortation 'let them play' that excludes the speaker. It is neither third person (which क्रीडन्तु is), nor second person, nor singular.